

Roadies parody show, Rowdies. While ViralFever.com has made several spoof videos of this series, the video called Rowdies 9 - Sab Q-tiyapa has registered over 700,000 hits and the concept came about because the creators couldn't understand why people went bonkers over the show.

His take on virality: "Like, with any contagious disease, two things are important. First, a virus needs to be something that you are not immune to, and second, for you to contract the disease you need to be exposed to it. The success of the virus then depends on the communities' threshold for that disease. That's why some people will 'get' it while some don't understand what the fuss is about. To be really contagious, the virus has to be new."

Viral content then, is like a disease, and if all conditions are perfect, the virus has potential to spread and become an 'epidemic'. Just imagine. The epidemic of the 'Asian Backstreet Boys' or 'Charlie the Unicorn'. Yes, you have our permission to crawl under your bed and shiver lest you catch the 'get stupid get famous' virus.

I'll try and decipher more later, but that's how much I've got so far. Interestingly, this magazine was able to identify it as a disease way back then. If only someone would have warned them about what the pointless clicking and the 'get stupid get famous' virus would do to humanity. What we call the P-virus today was already bothering some people two generations ago!

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I was able to piece together more of that article. Man they had terrible cameras in those days, with such horrible resolution pictures and videos. No wonder it's called the forgotten web!

Just in case you've been inspired by the stories of success we've highlighted, and now want to become an online sensation, we spoke to some viral content curators that are India's claim to online fame to understand whether there was a method to the madness and a secret formula, or was it just dumb luck. Utsav Agarwal, co-creator of Sb*t People in Mumbai Say and now founder of music sharing app #nowplyng feels

that there are two ways to go viral. "You can either create absolutely new content or jump on a trend. The effort should go into the content, as it must strike a chord with your audience".

Stress on the content like the man behind Gangnam Style did, and the rest will figure itself out. The crazy hopping guy has received close to 500 million views in 3 months and it's all because of a catchy tune and an absurd video. For those who haven't seen it – picture a guy doing a horse riding dance, intermittently singing below an ugly pelvic thrusting dude and a scantily dressed woman, and you have your answer.

Arunabh Kumar too believes that content is king. "The single most important foundation is for the creator to believe in his content. You must

it nowadays for the 6 PM reporters and daily journalists as they get a regular paycheck for telling us how many murders or thefts were committed while you fell asleep listening to Justin Bieber on loop.

Rupesh and Nikhil of popular blog aamchimumbai.org and Facebook page, Aamchi Mumbai, which has over 1.45 lakh Likes feel there's a method to the madness. "Yes, content is king, but a king requires a kingdom too, and the x factor is knowing and understanding why that particular content is being created. Like yourself, your content too needs a personality. Based on how you convey it – the choosing between a video v/s image, time of posting, quality and language of the content is all important..."

Based on these factors you'll either stumble upon genius creations such as The Annoying Thing aka Crazy Frog which is irritating yet funny, and share it with everyone; or you'll feel the content is a joke on itself and ignore it.

December 20, 2072 Even more...

I can't figure out whether this article was meant to serve as a warning in the early days or to encourage the spread of the P-virus.

Most of the references are greek to me, and the data

corruption of the forgotten

web archives in '64 has not helped. It's hard to piece the message together and also understand it. I'll leave it open ended, and you can help me understand it.

About 60 hours of videos are uploaded every hour on YouTube. Yet, a minuscule percentage of them go viral. But, don't let your viral career be discouraged by this fact. For the many that have failed, or for all the senseless videos such as the Double Rainbow video, virality has given many a great career as well.

Let's take Canadian Indian comedian Russell Peters as an example. An unheard of standup comedian who regularly participated in comedy line-ups in Canada, Peters' performance on the comedy series Comedy Now! was uploaded by a fan on YouTube in its 45-minute entirety. Subsequently various other snippets of his performance were uploaded and according to Peters, when those snippets made their way to those specified cultural groups he became a viral sensation. Today, widely known for his comedy punchlines such as "Somebody gonna get a hurt



Double Rainbows - one of life's great mysteries

have immense creative audacity and constantly try something new."

Content is shared for various reasons on the internet. We share because an article or video contains useful information, because we want to appear smart or because you simply connect with the piece of content and want others to share the emotional experience.

So, if you are aiming for your next video, blog, image etc. to go viral – what kind of content should you aim for? Should it be positive or negative? Well, research undertaken by the Journal of Marketing Research says that people would rather share positive stories, as they would prefer to be known as someone who shares upbeat stories and make people feel good rather than someone who shares things that makes others feel upset or sad. It is the typical Santa Claus v/s The Grinch that Stole Christmas theory. That is, on the internet it's more likely that stories that bring joy rather than doom and gloom will be the sharing preference. We can leave the doom and gloom or 'news' as they call